

overcome with the new Journal. For example, one such issue was the recent, much-discussed *kernel.org* intrusion involved log-file manipulation, which was only detected by chance. In addition, due to the limitations of *syslog*, users frequently have to rely on closed source components to make sense of the gathered logging data and make access to it efficient.

Journal comes as a solution to these issues. The design goals of Journal include simplicity, zero maintenance, robustness, portability, performance, integration, minimal footprint, general-purpose event storage, unification, security and much more.

Welcome to Androidland: The world's first Android store

Come and shop for your favourite Android-based smartphones and tablets under one roof. The Australian telecom operator, Telstra, has unveiled Androidland, the world's first Android store, at Melbourne. This Android retail store is based inside a Telstra flagship store, and brings together all the smartphones and tablets that run the Android OS within one 154 sq m of space. The store offers interactive technology, games and on-site experts to explain the features of Google's Android operating system.



Apart from the smartphones and tablets, Androidland also has plenty of exciting things in store for shoppers. It has an interactive spaceship zone, where users will be able to pilot the Google Earth app on the giant screen and fly across the world. They will also get a chance to play Angry Birds on a big interactive screen, along with creating an Android avatar that can be printed or shared.

Shoppers will also get a chance to have fun in the play-zone, which has a pixel tree. Visitors can sit under the pixel tree and play with live devices, flick through a virtual library of Google books, and also try their luck on an Android skill tester and clown machine. All this, apart from being able to get a hands-on experience of all the Android smartphones and tablets.

Android experts, specially trained by Google, will help visitors with setting up their Google accounts, recommend popular Android Market apps, answer questions and help customise device home-screens. Visitors will also have an opportunity to interact with a massive 24 x 9 metre window display that features an augmented reality game. This challenges visitors to catch Android robots drifting in a virtual snowfall.

Cluzee: Siri's Android alternative

Siri, the exclusive intelligent software-cum-personal assistant and knowledge navigator of iPhone 4S, is not exclusive any more. Android phone users also can now access a similar voice-controlled feature called Cluzee, developed by Tronton LLC, an emerging start-up poised to become the premier vendor of Virtual Personal Digital Assistants. The developers of Cluzee claim that it brings Siri-like features to Android devices. It is still to be seen whether Cluzee matches up to Siri, which was launched in October 2011.

Cluzee says, "Talk to your phone! I can help you save your time and money.

Blankets made from open source maps

Stamen, an award-winning design and technology studio in San Francisco, has introduced blankets and napkins made from open source maps. These unique blankets and napkins can be custom-printed to feature a street map of the buyer's favourite location, like a college campus or hometown.

Stamen Design uses open source software to access a kind of 'world-wide Wikipedia for maps' and turns it into custom textiles of choice.

Android 4.0 introduces features for the visually impaired

Now, even the visually impaired will be able to enjoy Android. Google is trying to improve the usability of its mobile OS for the visually impaired. One feature has a built-in voice, which will read out the names of the icon or the text on which the user's finger is resting. This will enable the user to find apps even without looking at the screen. Once the user has found what's needed, he can give the icon a small tap to launch it.

Games highest in Android's 10 billion downloads

Android games have notched up more than 2.5 billion downloads, since the launch of Google's Android Market store, accounting for a 25.6 per cent share of the store's first 10 billion downloads. After games, entertainment is the second most popular app category in terms of downloads, taking a 12.2 per cent share, followed by tools (11.17 per cent) and communication (6.45 per cent), with productivity, personalisation, music, audio and social all taking shares higher than 4 per cent. Other quirky stats include that 1.87m hours have been spent using the Android IMDb app in the last four months; 12 billion miles are navigated on Google Maps every year; nearly 1.8m Adele songs have been tagged using Shazam; and 4,054 years have been notched up in the Talking Tom app.